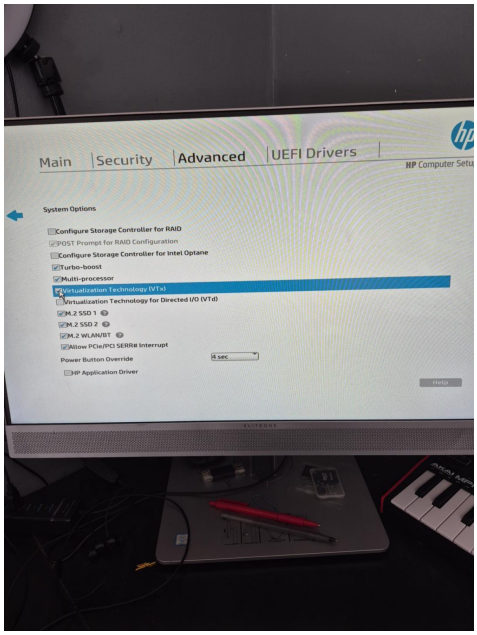
Active Directory & IT Support Lab — Day 1

Prepared by: Hasani Lewis **Date:** October 22, 2026

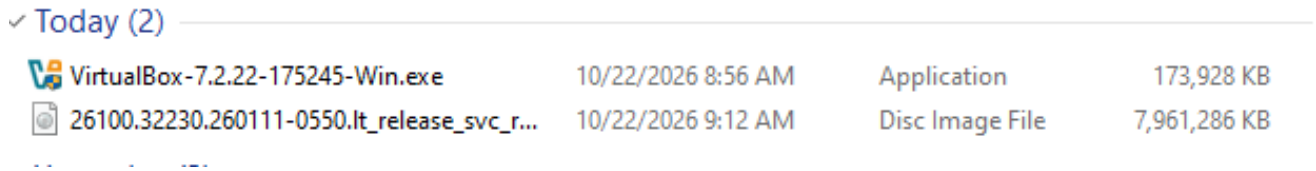
Outcome: Configured hardware virtualization, installed VirtualBox, deployed Windows Server 2025 Standard Evaluation (Desktop Experience), renamed the server DC01, verified NAT network connectivity, and created a clean-state snapshot.

1. BIOS: Virtualization enabled



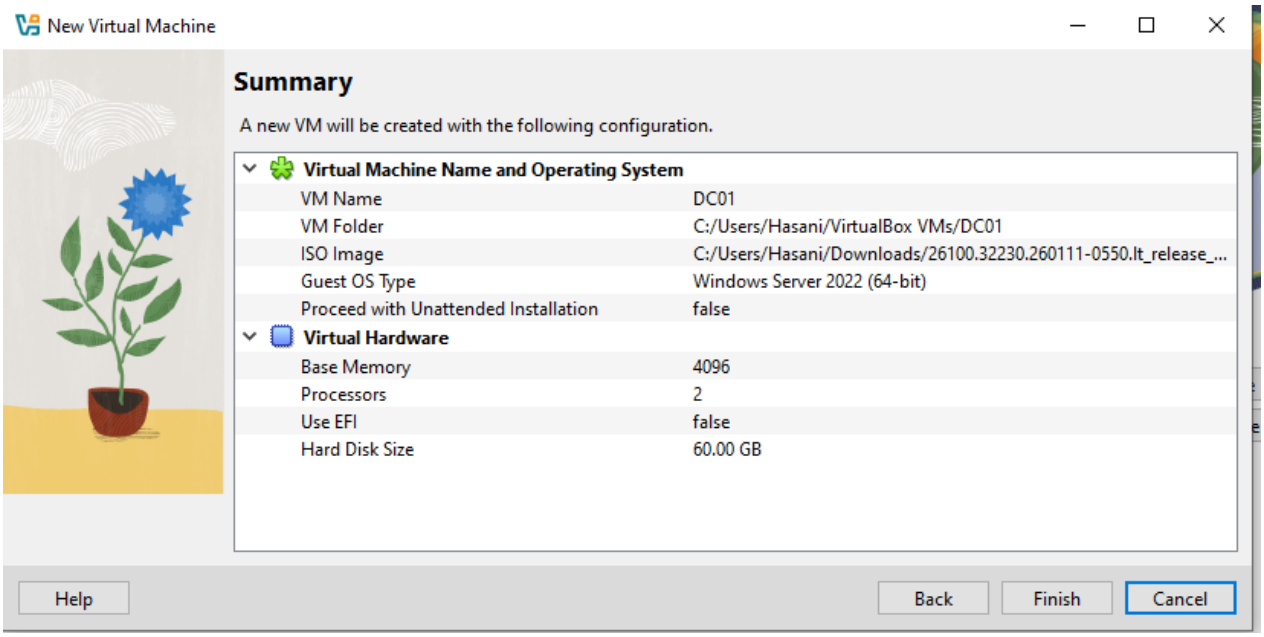
HP BIOS System Options shows Intel Virtualization Technology (VT-x) checked.

2. Downloaded installation media



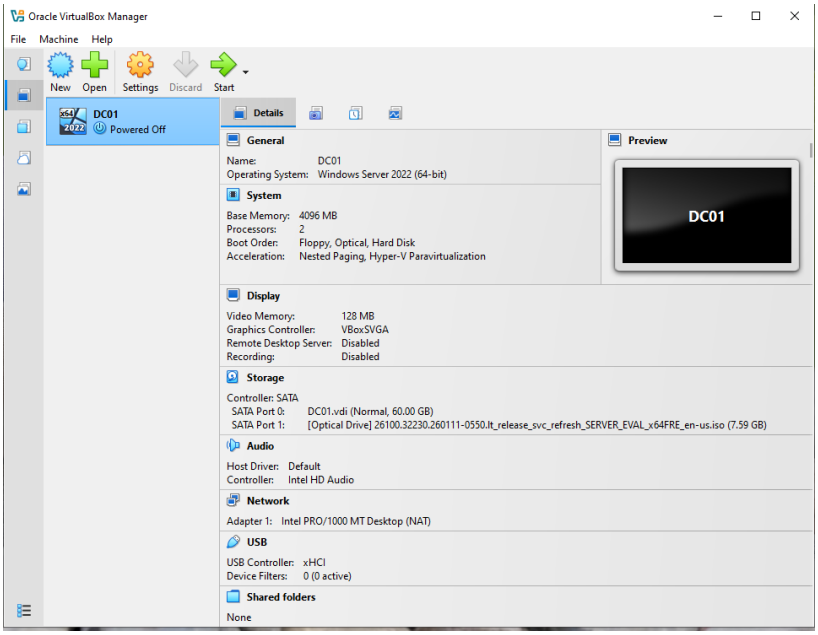
VirtualBox installer and Windows Server evaluation ISO downloaded.

3. VM creation summary



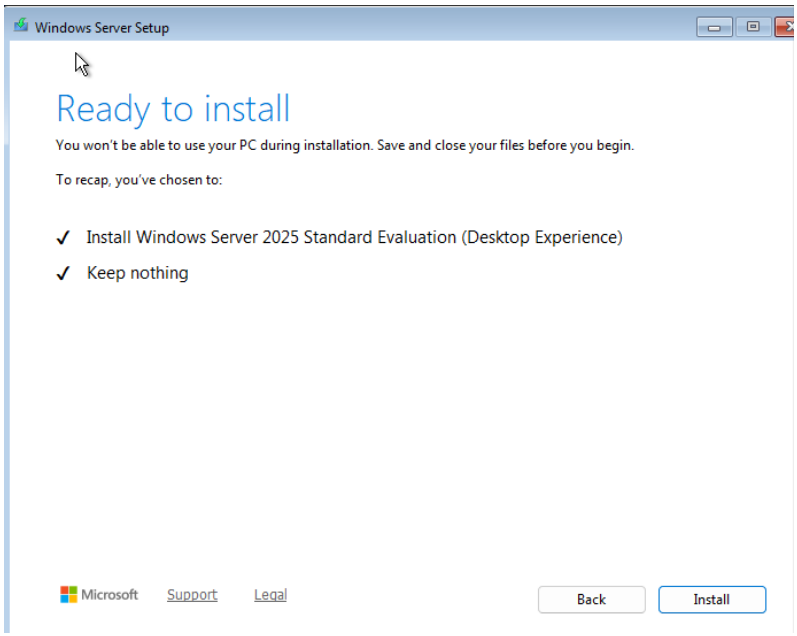
DC01 configured with 4 GB RAM, two CPUs, 60 GB disk and manual installation.

4. VirtualBox VM provisioned



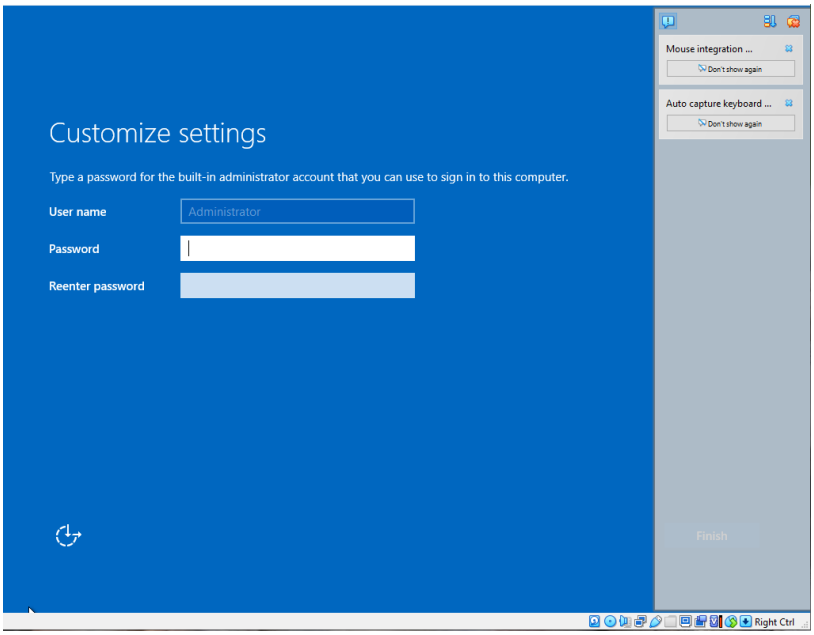
DC01 created with attached Windows Server ISO and NAT networking.

5. Windows Server installation selection



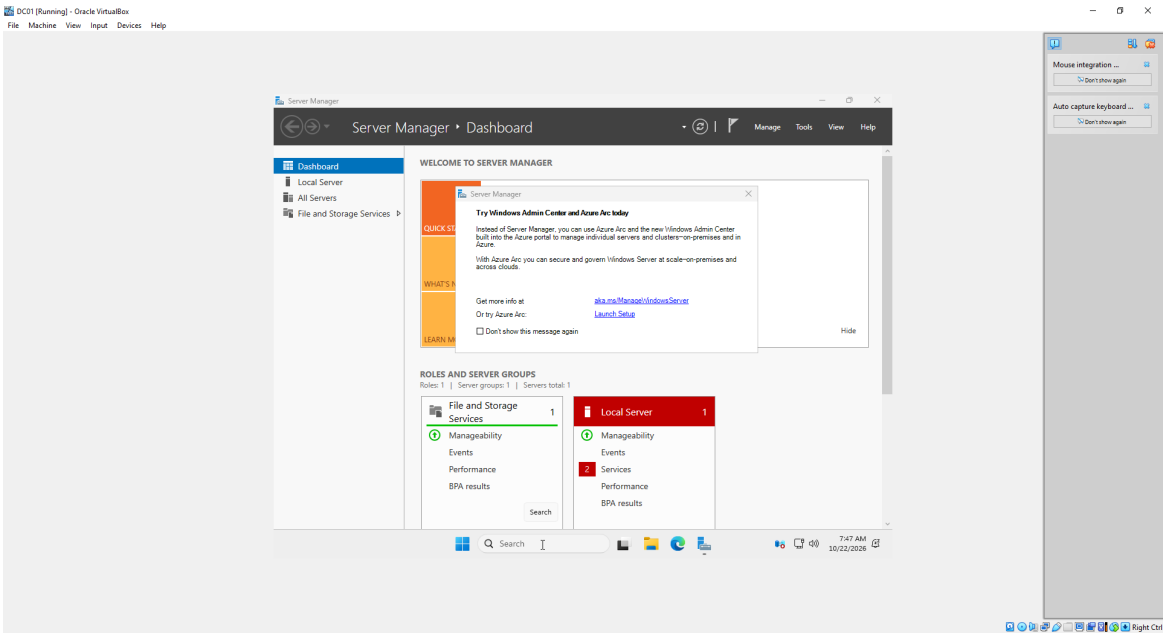
Windows Server 2025 Standard Evaluation (Desktop Experience) selected.

6. Initial administrator setup



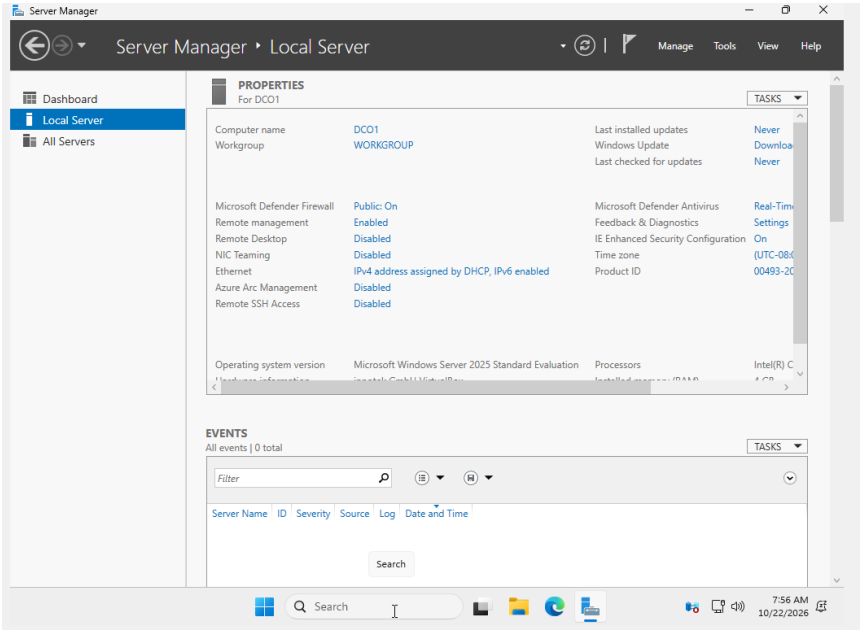
Built-in Administrator account initialized; no passwords are included.

7. Server Manager running



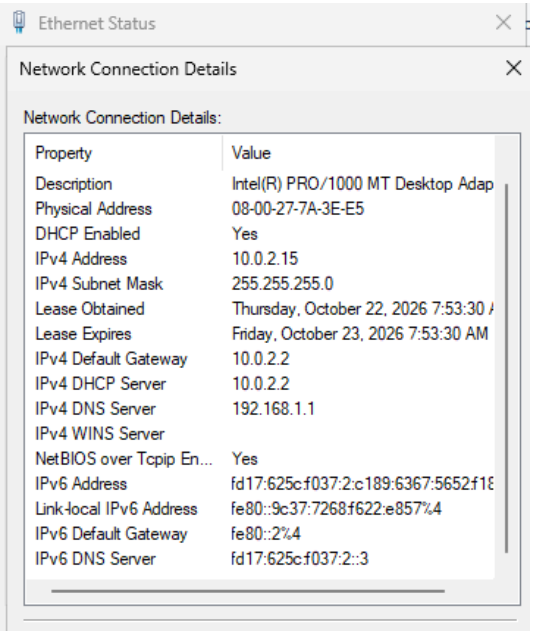
Successful login and Server Manager launch.

8. Computer name verified



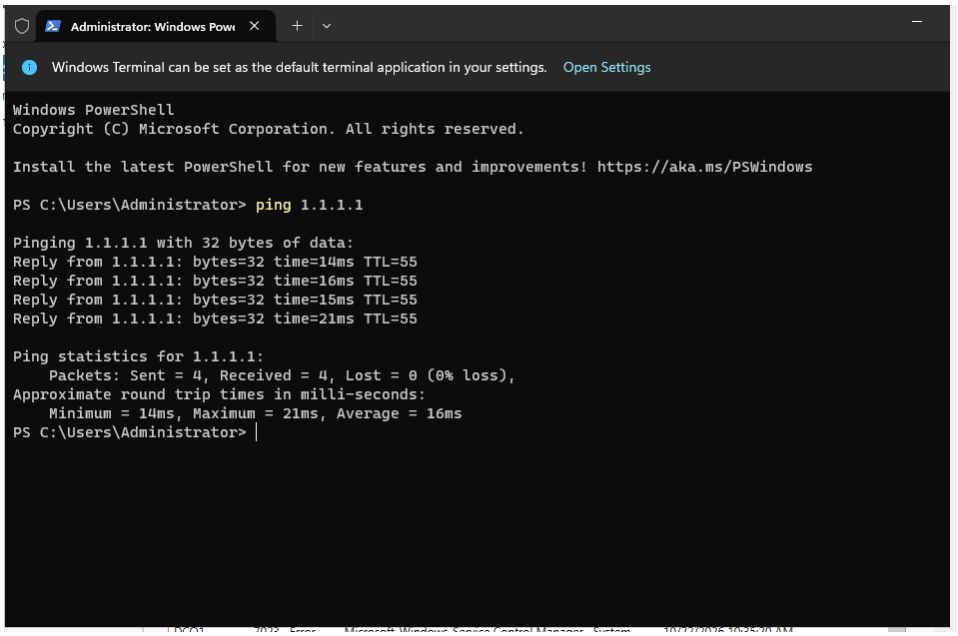
Windows Server renamed to DC01 and verified in Local Server.

9. Initial NAT addressing



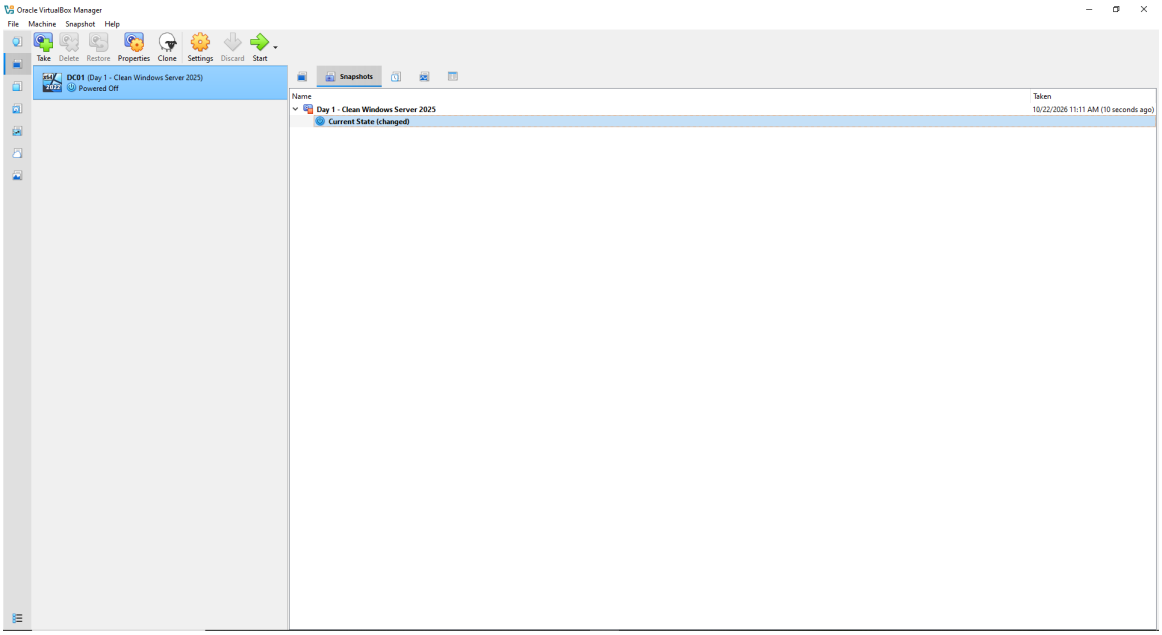
DHCP address 10.0.2.15, subnet mask 255.255.255.0, gateway 10.0.2.2.

10. Connectivity test



PowerShell ping to 1.1.1.1: 4 received, 0 lost, average 16 ms.

11. Day 1 recovery snapshot



Snapshot saved as Day 1 - Clean Windows Server 2025.

Next phase

Configure an isolated virtual network and a static IP address for DC01 before installing Active Directory Domain Services. This is a personal training lab, not a production deployment.